UK Data archive Study Number 9363 - British Social Attitudes Survey, 2023

National Centre for Social Research

British Social Attitudes: User Guide

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1. British Social Attitudes

The British Social Attitudes survey has been running since 1983. During that time, we have surveyed around 120,000 members of the public, each year asking up to 6,000 people up to 300 questions about their attitudes on a variety of topics ranging from welfare to genomic science. (The survey was not run in 1988 and 1992 when we ran the British Election Study series, which included relevant attitudinal questions.)

The British Social Attitudes (BSA) surveys inform the development of public policy and are an important barometer of public attitudes used by opinion leaders and social commentators. The topics we cover in each survey are determined by the interests of our funders, some questions have been asked every year, others every couple of years, and others less frequently. Repeating some questions over time means that we are able to provide a unique insight into how social attitudes have changed during the last four decades.

Each year we publish a report, freely available online, using the data we have collected to present a compelling picture of Britain's social, moral and political attitudes. Our latest report based on data collected in 2022 is our 40th Report: https://natcen.ac.uk/publications/bsa-40-overview .

2. Accessing the data

Users from non-commercial organisations can download the data directly from the UK Data Service. Access to the data requires Athens registration. You can download the data as SPSS or STATA files, or as a TAB file. Data is archived around a year after the completion of fieldwork (giving time for analysis and reporting).

Commercial organisations must notify the National Centre for Social Research by email (BSA@natcen.ac.uk) stating their intended use and seeking permission for download. Permission to download may incur a charge. UKDS will be monitoring usage and providing NatCen with usage reports.

3. What topics do the datasets cover?

From 2020, due to the pandemic, the British Social Attitudes has been administered with a mixed-mode design of web and CATI (telephone interviews), with no face-to-face interviews as in previous years. Questions from previous rounds, as well as new modules have been adapted for web self-completion and telephone interviewing.

In 2023 the survey covered the following topics:

Table 3.1 BSA 2023 Topics and corresponding funders

Topic	Funder
Employment	NatCen Social Research
Tenure	NatCen Social Research
Politics	NatCen Social Research
Benefits and income	NatCen Social Research
National identity and ethnicity	NatCen Social Research
Religion	NatCen Social Research
Disability	NatCen Social Research
Education	NatCen Social Research
Unfunded module	
Devolution	NatCen Social Research
Electoral voting reform	NatCen Social Research
Trust in the political system	NatCen Social Research
Immigration	NatCen Social Research
Economic issues	NatCen Social Research
Equal opportunities for protected groups	NatCen Social Research
Cost of living/inflation	NatCen Social Research
Climate change	NatCen Social Research
Environmental issues	NatCen Social Research
Monarchy	NatCen Social Research
Trade Union membership	NatCen Social Research
Welfare module	
Online benefit claims	Department for Work and Pensions
Health benefits	Department for Work and Pensions
Housing benefits	Department for Work and Pensions
Attitudes towards DWP	Department for Work and Pensions
Pensions and retirement	Department for Work and Pensions
Poverty	Department for Work and Pensions
Child maintenance	Department for Work and Pensions
Fraud and error	Department for Work and Pensions
Health and Social Care module	
Satisfaction with health and care services	King's Fund & Nuffield Trust

Health and care spending	King's Fund & Nuffield Trust
NHS priorities and principles	King's Fund & Nuffield Trust
Attitudes towards building new homes	
New build homes	Department for Levelling Up, Housing & Communities
Social housing	Department for Levelling Up, Housing & Communities
Energy efficiency of homes	Department for Levelling Up, Housing & Communities
Home ownership	Department for Levelling Up, Housing & Communities
Gypsy, Roma and Traveller communities	Department for Levelling Up, Housing & Communities
International Social Survey Programme	
National Identity	Economic and Social Research Council
Citizenship	Economic and Social Research Council
European Union	Economic and Social Research Council

A wide range of background and classificatory questions are also always included. A number of the same questions are asked most years, enabling us to track change over time.

4. The sample

In 2023 the sample for the British Social Attitudes survey was split into 10 versions.
The table below illustrates the modules, their corresponding versions and the number of complete and partial responses achieved.

Table 4.2 BSA 2023 Module versioning and number of achieved responses

Module	V1	V2	V3	V4	V5	V6	V7	V8	V9	V10	Responses achieved	
											Full completes	Partial completes
Classification	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	5386	192
Welfare		■	■	■	■	■	■				3178	106
Health & Social Care[1]	■	■									1046	32
Devolution	■		■								1203	35
Voting reform	■		■								1203	35
Trust in Government	■		■								1203	35
European Union	■			■							1187	30
Immigration	■			■							1187	30
Economic issues	■			■							1187	30
Equal opportunities	■			■							1187	30
Inflation/ cost of living	■						■				1187	32
Climate chage	■				■						1185	41
Environmental issues	■				■						1185	41
Monarchy	■					■					1237	39
Trade Union membership	■							■	■	■	2273	82
Building new homes	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	5386	192
International Social Survey Programme								■	■	■	1542	60

The British Social Attitudes survey is designed to yield a representative sample of adults aged 18 or over. Since 1993, the sampling frame for the survey has been the **Postcode Address File** (PAF), a list of addresses (or postal delivery points) compiled by the Post Office. For practical reasons, the sample is confined to those living in private households. People living in institutions (though not in private households at such institutions) are excluded, as are households whose addresses are not on the PAF.

A sample file of non-clustered addresses was produced from the PAF. Addresses north of the Caledonian Canal and on the Isles of Scilly were excluded for consistency with previous years of BSA. 36,521 total addresses were then allocated to a main sample (N= 30,436) and a reserve sample (n=6,085). The reserve sample was not issued in 2023.

The Multiple-Occupancy Indicator (MOI) available through PAF was used when selecting addresses in Scotland. The MOI indicates the number of dwelling units at an individual address. If the MOI indicated more than one dwelling unit at a given address, the probability of the address being selected from the

[1] Two questions were also included in version 3-5 and 7

list of addresses would increase so that it matched the total number of dwelling units. The MOI is largely irrelevant in England and Wales, as separate dwelling units (DUs) generally appear as separate entries on PAF. In Scotland, tenements with many flats tend to appear as one entry on PAF. However, even in Scotland, 99.9% of the MOIs in the sample had a value of one. The remainder had MOIs greater than one. The MOI affects the selection probability of the address, so it was necessary to incorporate an adjustment for this into the weighting procedures (described below).

Selection of individuals

Up to two individuals aged 18 or over living at the selected addresses were eligible to take part. The invitation and reminder letters contained two unique access codes allowing any two adults aged 18+ living within the household to log in and complete the survey.

5. Fieldwork

Fieldwork was carried out between 12th September and 31st October 2023.

Fieldwork used a mixed-mode design, offering the choice of both web and telephone survey completion. The fieldwork period was the same for both modes. The invitation and first reminder letters sent to respondents encouraged participants to take part online, while giving them the option to take part by phone if they wanted to. The letter and first reminder emphasised the option to take part by web. The second reminder letter made the option to take part by phone more explicit.

Telephone fieldwork was conducted by interviewers drawn from the National Centre for Social Research's regular panel. Before fieldwork began, interviewers attended a briefing conference to familiarise themselves with the questionnaire. A total of 52 interviews were conducted via phone and 5526 interviews were completed via web.

The mean interview length for each version of the questionnaire was:

Version 1	30 minutes,43 seconds
Version 2	31 minutes,41 seconds
Version 3	31 minutes,20 seconds
Version 4	30 minutes,42 seconds
Version 5	29 minutes,21 seconds
Version 6	29 minutes,42 seconds
Version 7	28 minutes,42 seconds
Version 8	31 minutes,01 seconds
Version 9	30 minutes,46 seconds
Version 10	29 minutes,54 seconds

Overall, we achieved a household response rate of between 14.5% and 16.1%. Details are shown in Table 5.1.

Table 5.3 BSA 2023 response rate

Issued sample	60,872 cases 30,436 addresses
Estimate number of deadwood/ineligible[2]	10%
Eligible addresses	27,392
Number of fully productive cases	5,386
Number of partially productive cases	192
Number of addresses with at least one complete (full or partial)	4,404
Number of completes per address	1.27
Unadjusted household response rate	14.5%

[2] Estimate based on BSA 2019 % of ineligible

Adjusted household response rate[3]	16.1%

Advance mailings
Sampled addresses were sent an advance letter on the 12th of September, inviting adults aged 18 or over and resident at the household to take part in the survey. Up to two adults could take part in each household. Participants had the option to complete the survey via web or by telephone. Non-responsive households were sent two reminder letters, which included the access codes for the web survey and the BSA telephone contact number.

Incentives
In 2023 we conducted an incentive experiment to test whether increasing the value of the incentive would have a positive impact on response rates. As per previous years, for the majority of participants (those on versions 2-10) a £10 voucher was issued upon completion of the survey and sent out to the respondents via email or post. Households allocated to version 1 were offered a £15 voucher upon completion to be sent via email or post. Table 5.2. shows the response rates for those who were offered a £10 voucher compared to those offered a £15 voucher.

Table 5.2 Response rates for different incentive values

	£10	**£15**
Household response rate[4]	15.7%	19.3%

[3] The number of households with at least one response as a proportion of all the eligible sample (i.e. adjusted for deadwood)
[4] Adjusted household response rate

6. Weighting the data

As with previous waves of the BSA, weights have been constructed to adjust for differential non-response. The "push-to-web" methodology means that non-response could occur both at the address level, as well as within households. This contrasts with pre-pandemic BSA iterations which were conducted face-to face, and one adult was selected at random at each address, and selection weights were used to account for differential selection probabilities.

As described in section four, addresses were selected with equal probability, and up to two people in one household at each address were invited to take part. Weighting was therefore required to adjust for non-response *within* households in addition to accounting for non-response amongst households at selected addresses. Separate non-response models were constructed to deal with each of these elements of non-response. Finally, calibration weighting was used to adjust the profile of the responding sample to match the population in terms of age, sex, education, tenure, ethnicity, economic activity and region.

To minimise non-response bias, data should be weighted in all univariate analyses. Weighting is also recommended for multivariate analysis. The file is not pre-weighted: before running any analysis, please "switch on" the NatCen computed weight **(BSA23_final_wt)**.

There is only one weight available for 2023. Differently from when the survey was conducted face-to-face, there is no selection weight (see above) and no separate self-completion weight (pre-pandemic selected questions which were more likely to be affected by social desirability bias were completed by respondents themselves rather than being asked by an interviewer, hence a separate self-completion weight was included).

Non-response models

It is known that certain subgroups in the population are more likely to respond to surveys than others. These groups can end up over-represented in the responding sample, which can lead to bias in the survey estimates. Given that up to two people per household could respond this year, non-response can occur at the household level, where no one from the selected address responds, or within households, where only one person responds in households with two or more adults. Where information is available about non-responding addresses, propensity for households (at selected addresses) to respond can be modelled, and the results used to generate a non-response weight. Similarly, where information is available about responding households, the expected number of responses within these households can also be modelled. Hence, this year there are two non-response weights for households – one for between household non-response and one for within household non-response. These are intended to reduce bias in the responding sample resulting from differential response to the survey.

Between household response was modelled using logistic regression, with the dependent variable indicating whether or not someone at each selected address responded to the survey. A number of area-level variables, including aggregated census data and deprivation indices were considered for modeling response. From this model, the between household non-response weight was calculated as the inverse of the predicted response probability for each responding household.

Within household response was also modelled using logistic regression, with the dependent variable indicating whether each responding address had one or two responses to the survey. Single-adult[5] addresses and non-responding addresses were not included in this stage of non-response modelling. As well as the area-level information used before, additional household-level variables such as household size, tenure, whether anyone in the household has a degree and income were also considered. The predicted probability from the model was used to estimate the expected number of completed surveys in responding households. This was calculated as 1 x (1-p) + 2 x p = 1+p, where p is the probability of two responses. The within household non-response weight was calculated as the ratio of the number of adults in the household (capped at 4) divided by the expected number of responses for each responding household, i.e. numad / (1+p), where numad is the number of adults in the household (capped at 4).

The composite (pre-calibration) weight was calculated as the product of the two non-response weights above.

Calibration weighting
In the final stage of weighting, calibration was used to adjust the composite non-response weight (from the previous stages) so that the weighted sample was in line with the best available population estimates of GB adults for: sex by age, region, education by age, ethnicity and housing tenure.

Population estimates for age, sex, and region in England and Wales were sourced from the 2022 mid-year population estimates released by the Office for National Statistics. Scottish population estimates, were derived from the 2021 mid-year population estimates published by the General Register Office for Scotland. The latest Labour Force Survey informed population estimates for education, ethnicity and housing tenure. These are the most recent estimates at the time of weighting.

The final calibrated weight (**BSA23_final_wt**) has been scaled to the responding sample size. It should be used for all analyses of BSA 2023.

7. Analysing the data

BSA provides a compelling account of the public's economic, political, moral and social attitudes over the last 41 years. It can be used to provide an annual snapshot of the public's attitudes through an analysis of a single dataset or to create a narrative of the public's attitudes over a period of time by analysing several datasets.

A number of questions have been repeated over the years. Unless the question wording has been changed, the original variable name has been retained. Questions have been optimised for web and telephone modes, as per 2020, 2021 and 2022. The 2023 survey data used very similar methods to 2020, 2021 and 2022, so comparisons can be made here however caution is needed when presenting findings from BSA 2023 alongside survey years before year 2020, as differences between years may be due to the change in survey mode.

Please note that the data must be weighted in all analysis. The file is not pre-weighted.
Before running any analysis, please weight the data using the NatCen computed weight (BSA23_final_wt). As long as the weight is included when specifying the sample design, the complex sample procedures will ensure that the data is weighted; however, other procedures may not weight the data automatically.

Versions 1 to 10 are geographically unclustered but up to two people in each household are able to take part, so the sample is clustered at the household level. When using complex sample procedures we would recommend using region (GOR) as the stratification variable, and household serial (serialh) as the cluster variable.

Unlike some other surveys, on British Social Attitudes responses of 'Don't know' or 'Prefer not to answer' are considered to be valid responses and should be included in the base for analysis.

There are a number of identification variables that users may find useful in analyses. These are listed below. In addition, there are a number of potentially useful derived variables that are outlined in the following section.

Table 7.4 Demographic variables

DVSex23	Respondent's sex
RAgeCat	Respondent's age group
RaceOri4	Respondent's ethnicity
ReligSum	Respondent's religion
REarn	Total gross individual income
HEdQual2	Respondent's highest educational qualification
MarStat6	Respondent's marital status
TenHhl	Respondent's tenure

ReconAct	Respondent's economic activity (priority coded)
HhlAdGpd	Number of adults in household (grouped)
HhlChlGpd	Number of children in household (grouped)
BestNatu2	Nationality that best describes the respondent

Derived variables
The following derived variables are included in the datasets as standard:

Age
RAgeCat (dv) splits respondent's age into eight age categories, pulling information from RespAge (asked from all respondents) and Ragebnd (which collects banded age from respondents who refused to give an answer at RespAge). As per 2022, an additional category (70+) has also been included.

RageCat2 groups respondents' age into three categories (18-34, 35-54, 55+).

Gender
This variable categorises respondent's gender into male, female and 'other gender identity' based on their responses at the question asking whether their gender is the same as their sex as registered on their birth certificate.

Disability and effect on daily life
This variable splits respondents into three categories: i) they have a disability which affects their daily life ii) they have a disability but it doesn't affect their daily life and iii) they don't have a disability. The DV is computed using variables Disact2 and Disnew3.

Region
The dataset includes a region variable [GOR], which categorises cases into 14 regions, formerly the Government Office Regions. [GOR] combines Inner London and Outer London into one region. Earlier datasets between 2003–2016 use GOR2 (although GOR_ID is also available); from 2000-2002 the equivalent variable was [GOR]. Before 2000, (1983–1999) [StRegion] was the variable denoting region. It should be noted that the coding of these variables are not the same, and that [GOR2] splits London into 'outer' and 'inner'. Users should be aware of potentially small sample sizes for regional subgroups, and the implications that has for analysis.

Table 7.5 Government office regions categories

Code	StRegion (1983–1999)	GOR (2000–2002)	GOR2 (2003–2016)	GOR_ID (2017-2020)	GOR
1	Scotland	North East	North East	North East	North East
2	North of England	North West	North West	North West	North West
3	North West	Merseyside	Yorkshire and the Humber	Yorkshire and the Humber	Yorkshire and the Humber
4	Yorks and Humberside	Yorkshire & Humber	East Midlands	East Midlands	East Midlands
5	West Midlands	East Midlands	West Midlands	West Midlands	West Midlands
6	East Midlands	West Midlands	East of England	East of England	East of England
7	East Anglia	South West	Inner London	London	London
8	South West	East of England	Outer London	South East	South East
9	South East (excl. Greater London)	South East	South East	South West	South West
10	Greater London	London	South West	Wales	Wales
11	Wales	Wales	Wales	Scotland	Scotland
12		Scotland	Scotland		Northern Ireland
13					Channel Islands
14					Isle of Man

Standard Occupational Classification and National Statistics Socio-Economic Classification
Respondents are classified according to their own occupation, not that of the 'head of household'. Each respondent was asked about their current or last job, so that all respondents except those who had never worked were coded. Just as in 2022, for the 2023 survey respondents were asked to self-code their current or last job into an 8 category variable (EmpOCC). An employment status that captures information on employment status and supervisory status has also been derived (EmployB) based on REconAct and REconFW.

An employment status variable that captures information on employment status and size of organisation was also derived (EmplStatDV) based on questions collecting information on whether an individual is:

- an employer, self-employed or an employee (EMPSTAT);
- size of organisation (employ); and
- supervisory status (Superv).

The National Statistics Socio-Economic Classification (NS-SEC) was derived from a combination of information on occupation and employment status. In the dataset this variable is called 'RClassGP'. It is important to note this difference how the NS-SEC variable was derived this year, and to take this into account when comparing findings from previous survey years.

For some analyses, it may be more appropriate to classify respondents according to their current socio-economic status, which takes into account only their present economic position. Respondents can be allocated to one of the following categories: "in full time education/training", "in work, waiting to

take up work", "on maternity or paternity leave", "unemployed", "retired" or "other" using the data recorded at REconsum.

Note on analysing changing attitudes by social class over time
When analysing how the attitudes of different social classes have changed over time, you need to use a variable that gives a comparable measure of social class across the lifetime of the survey (during which class has been measured using a range of different variables). There is no perfect solution, but our strong preference is to use Goldthorpe-Heath (5 category version) class – RGHClass – before the 2000 SOC became a standard feature of the survey in 2000, and NS-SEC analytic class – RNSEG – thereafter. At the 5-class level these two schemes are conceptually based on more or less the same principles. (You can only do this going back to 1987.) For **BSA 2016 and later years** a variable RNSEGD has been included in the data set which bands RNSEG into 5 categories. Before 2016, a 5-category variable can be derived using RNSEG and the following syntax:

For BSA 2001 up until BSA 2015 use: RNSEGD (derived as below)
RECODE RNSEG (1, 2, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8 = 1) (9 = 2) (3, 15, 16, 17 = 3) (11, 12 = 4) (10, 13, 14, 18 = 5) (else = sysmis) into RNSEGD.
Execute.
Variable labels RNSEGD "RNSEG compressed".
Value labels RNSEGD
1 "Salariat (Higher & Lower)"
2 "Clerical (Junior non-manual)"
3 "Petty Bourgeois"
4 "Foremen/Technicians"
5 "Working class"
99 "Don't know".

For BSA 2000 and earlier years use: RGHClass (1983 Heath Goldthorpe scale)
RECODE **RGHClass** (1 thru 2 = 1) (3 thru 4 = 2) (5 thru 7 = 3) (8 = 4) (9 thru 11 = 5) (else = sysmis) into RGHClassD.
Execute.
Variable labels RGHClassD "RGHClass compressed".
Value labels RGHClassD
1 "Professional / managerial"
2 "Routine"
3 "Small petty bourgeoisie / farmers"
4 "Manual"
5 "Other manual"
99 "Don't know".

Income
The BSA dataset includes a standard measure of household income [HHIncome]. This year, respondents were asked to place themselves into banded income quartiles. The bandings used are designed to be representative of those that exist in Britain and are taken from the Family Resources Survey (see http://research.dwp.gov.uk/asd/frs). REarn asked respondents currently in work to place themselves within estimated earnings quartiles.

Attitude scales
Since 1986, BSA surveys have included two attitude scales which aim to measure where respondents stand on certain underlying value dimensions: left–right and libertarian–authoritarian. Since 1987

(except in 1990), a similar scale on 'welfarism' has also been included. Some of the items in the welfarism scale were changed in 2000–2001. The current version of the scale is shown below.
A useful way of summarising the information from a number of questions of this sort is to construct an additive index (Spector, 1992; DeVellis, 2003). This approach rests on the assumption that there is an underlying – 'latent' – attitudinal dimension which characterises the answers to all the questions within each scale. If so, scores on the index are likely to be a more reliable indication of the underlying attitude than the answers to any one question.

Each of these scales consists of a number of statements to which the respondent is invited to "agree strongly", "agree", "neither agree nor disagree", "disagree" or "disagree strongly". The items are:

Left–right scale (5 items) [leftrigh]
Government should redistribute income from the better off to those who are less well off. [Redistrb]

Big business benefits owners at the expense of workers. [BigBusnN]

Ordinary working people do not get their fair share of the nation's wealth. [Wealth]

There is one law for the rich and one for the poor. [RichLaw]

Management will always try to get the better of employees if it gets the chance. [Indust4]

Libertarian–authoritarian scale (6 items) [libauth]
Young people today don't have enough respect for traditional British values. [TradVals]

People who break the law should be given stiffer sentences. [StifSent]

For some crimes, the death penalty is the most appropriate sentence. [DeathApp]

Schools should teach children to obey authority. [Obey]

The law should always be obeyed, even if a particular law is wrong. [WrongLaw]

Censorship of films and magazines is necessary to uphold moral standards. [Censor]

Welfarism scale (8 items) [welfare2][6]
The welfare state encourages people to stop helping each other. [WelfHelp]

The government should spend more money on welfare benefits for the poor, even if it leads to higher taxes. [MoreWelf]

Around here, most unemployed people could find a job if they really wanted one. [UnempJob]

Many people who get social security don't really deserve any help. [SocHelp]

[6] The welfare scale includes all 8 welfare items, however in the spec welfare2 only refers to 4 items; this is a discrepancy between the spec and the datasets, however the scale with all 8 items should be used when measuring welfarism as this is how It has been constructed in previous iterations of BSA

Most people on the dole are fiddling in one way or another. [DoleFidl]

If welfare benefits weren't so generous, people would learn to stand on their own two feet. [WelfFeet]

Cutting welfare benefits would damage too many people's lives. [DamLives]

The creation of the welfare state is one of Britain's proudest achievements. [ProudWlf]

The indices for the three scales are formed by scoring the leftmost, most libertarian or most pro-welfare position, as 1 and the rightmost, most authoritarian or most anti-welfarist position, as 5. The "neither agree nor disagree" option is scored as 3. All the items in the libauth scale have been reversed coded as well as items Unemjob to Welfhelp on the welfare scale.

The scores to all the questions in each scale are added and then divided by the number of items in the scale, giving indices ranging from 1 (leftmost, most libertarian, most pro-welfare) to 5 (rightmost, most authoritarian, most anti-welfare).

Items that were coded as "Don't know" or "refusals" in the individual scale items were recoded as 3 (mid-point value of the scale) if the number of valid items was three or more in the left-right (total = 5 items) and libertarian-authoritarian scale (total = 6 items) and five or more in the welfare scale (total = 8 items). If the number of valid items was lower than those specified (and therefore there was a greater number of "don't know"/ "refusals" (thus preventing us to derive a scale score), the scale value for those individuals was set to "missing" and given a code of 9. If a user wishes to look at average scores they will need to declare these values as 'missing'.

The scores on the three indices have been placed on the dataset.

The scales were tested for reliability (as measured by Cronbach's alpha) using the BSA 2023 data. The Cronbach's alpha (unstandardised items) for the scales in 2023 were 0.84 for the left–right scale, 0.89 for the welfarism scale and 0.80 for the libertarian authoritarian scale. This level of reliability can generally be considered 'good' for the left–right, welfare scales and the libertarian authoritarian scale (DeVellis, 2003: 95–96)

Multi-code variables

Where a respondent was given the opportunity to give more than one response at a question, we have created binary variables for each response option available. These binary variables record the number of respondents who chose that response option. If a respondent answered "don't know" or refused to answer a multi-code question, the "don't know" or "prefer not to answer" response has been included at each of the binary variables.

For variables WhySat, WhyDis and WhycareSat respondents were instructed to select up to three responses for each of the questions. Each of the variables is presented in the dataset with three different versions e.g. WhySat1, WhySat2 and WhySat3, and these reflect the proportion of respondents giving each answer when selecting 1, 2 or 3 answer options respectively. Not all respondents selected three options, some may have only selected, one or two, and this is reflected in the number of respondents which decreases from WhySat1 (N=400) to WhySat3 (N=292).

Open-ended questions
Questions that had an "Other – Please specify" option have been back-coded into the questions' existing categories. Where the answers in the free-text did not fit into any of the existing categories new categories have been created if a sufficient number of responses could be grouped in that category; otherwise responses have been coded as "Other specific answer not in code-frame", "Vague or irrelevant answer" or "Editor unable to code".

The following variables were coded:

List of coded variables	
RspGndr	NwHtyp
LegStat	EnrgMot
ReConFW	NatIdGB
Tenhhl	RelRFW
ISSP_UrbRur	RelFFW
PartyFW	NationU
DigBnHow	BNationU
DWPPref	RaceOri3_Black
DWPOnl	RaceOri3_Asian
PenAdv	RaceOri3_Mixed
WhySat	RaceOri3_Other
WhyDis	F_BORN
WhycareSat	M_BORN
WhyCDissat	Hedqual2
NHSPriority1	Maininc5_Othstate
YSupblt2	Maininc5_Othmain
PRISNEW	HIncdif4

Notes on other variables
BNationU is a follow-up question to NationU which is a multi-coded question that asks people what nationality they identify as. This question also contains an open-response option "Other" asking people to specify their nationality if not included in any of the response options. This open question has been back-coded. BNationU asks people to select the option that *best* describes their nationality and this year it will pull in the back-coded response from NationU. This does not appear to have been done in previous year, and the "Other" category was presented in its raw form rather than taking into account that NationU has been back-coded. We believe this will provide a more precise presentation of the data, however it does mean that the question may be slightly different from previous years and not directly comparable.

8. Further information

For further information on anything contained in this booklet please contact: **bsa@natcen.ac.uk**


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